SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

14 November 2024 · Shift 3

75 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 15 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 12 questions

Q.4

Two trains of lengths 110 m and 100 m are running towards each other on parallel lines at the speed of 50 km/h and 58 km/h, respectively. How long will they take to cross each other after they meet?

(A) 7 seconds
(B) 5 seconds
(C) 4 seconds
(D) 6 seconds

Q.6

What is the HCF of 513,1134 and 1215?

(A) 3
(B) 27
(C) 81
(D) 19

Q.7

If a semi-circular plot has radius 100 m, find its perimeter. (Use $\pi = 3.14$)

(A) 414 m
(B) 514 m
(C) 828 m
(D) 500 m

Q.8

A train increases its regular speed by 12.5% and reaches its destination 20 minutes earlier. What is the actual time taken by the train on the journey?

(A) 150 min
(B) 180 min
(C) 120 min
(D) 110 min

Q.9

A shop has two promotional offers: buy three shirts, get one shirt free, or a 25% discount on the marked price. If a customer buys five using both offers, what discount will he get all together?

(A) 30%
(B) 50%
(C) 27.5%
(D) 25%

Q.10

The quantity of milk ordered on the first, second, third and fourth day of a four day ceremony is in the proportion of 30 litres, 24 litres, 35 litres and ‘x’ litres, respectively. Find the quantity of milk (in litres) ordered on the fourth day.

(A) 26
(B) 32
(C) 30
(D) 28

Q.14
For a sum of ₹15,000 the rate of interest of 8.5% per annum simple interest, find the interest earned (in ₹) in 5 years 3 months.

(A) 21,375
(B) 21,693.75
(C) 6,375
(D) 6,693.75

Q.15
The average weight of Rakesh and his five friends is 62 kg. If Rakesh is 6 kg heavier than the average weight of his five friends, then find the weight of Rakesh.

(A) 61 kg
(B) 62 kg
(C) 67 kg
(D) 68 kg

Q.17
A solid hemisphere of radius 12 cm is melted into N identical cones, each of radius 6 cm and height 8 cm. What is the value of N?

(A) 10
(B) 12
(C) 15
(D) 8

Q.18
The average weight of a family of five members (in kg) whose weights are 40 kg, 49 kg, 56 kg, 68 kg and 38 kg is:

(A) 51.2
(B) 49.2
(C) 52.2
(D) 50.2

Q.19
Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹3500 as a sum borrowed at 7% per year rate of interest for 4 years.

(A) 980
(B) 920
(C) 1020
(D) 940

Q.20
What sum (in ₹) will earn a simple interest of ₹360 in 3 years at 12% per year rate of interest?

(A) 1500
(B) 500
(C) 2000
(D) 1000

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 15 questions

Q.1
'RJ 17' is related to 'QL 19' in a certain way. In the same way, 'CP 12' is related to 'BR 14'. To which of the following is 'OJ 22' related following the same logic?

(A) QJ 22
(B) PK 23
(C) NL 24
(D) NK 21

Q.2
What will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '×' are interchanged and '–' and '÷' are interchanged? 78 – 6 ÷ 6 + 2 × 8 = ?

(A) 7
(B) 9
(C) 4
(D) 0

Q.3

A, B, C, D, E, F, G and H are sitting around a circular table facing out to the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). D is sitting to the immediate left of A and third to the right of H. B is sitting third to the right of F. F is the immediate neighbour of C and G. C is sitting third to the right of A. Who is sitting fourth to the right of A?

(A) B
(B) C
(C) D
(D) H

Q.4

What will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? 24 × 576 ÷ 72 – 108 + 91 = ?

(A) 12
(B) 18
(C) 2
(D) 20

Q.5

In a certain code language, 'GOES' is coded as '4268' and 'OILY' is coded as '3457'. What is the code for 'O' in the given code language?

(A) 3
(B) 4
(C) 2
(D) 5

Q.6

In a certain code language, 'you read book' is written as 'hm rn op' and 'book is good' is written as 'cf am rn'. What is the code for 'book' in that language?

(A) op
(B) cf
(C) rn
(D) am

Q.7

A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). B sits to the immediate left of E. C sits to the immediate left of F. F sits second to the left of G. D sits third to the left of E. Who sits third to the left of A?

(A) G
(B) F
(C) B
(D) E

Q.8

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All papayas are oranges. Some oranges are apples. Conclusions: (I) At least some apples are oranges. (II) Some papayas are apples.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Only conclusion II follows
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(D) Bothconclusion I and II follow

Q.11

In the following number-pairs, the second number is obtained by applying certain mathematical operations to the first number. Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/ subtracting /multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 8, 72; 11, 99

(A) 19, 131
(B) 21, 123
(C) 15, 125
(D) 17, 153

Q.13

In a certain code language, 'MONKEY' is coded as 'BHNQRP' and 'NAP' is coded as 'SDQ'. What is the code for 'JUTEBAG' in the given code language?

(A) JDEHWXN
(B) JDEHUXM
(C) JDEKWXM
(D) JDEHWXM

Q.15

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order? XCW, UGS, RKO ,?, LSG

(A) OOM
(B) OOK
(C) OLO
(D) OMN

Q.16

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some tomatoes are potatoes. No potato is an onion. Conclusions: (I) Some potatoes are not tomatoes. (II) No tomato is an onion.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows

Q.17

CDFG is related to FGIJ in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, MNPQ is related to PQST. To which of the following is HIKL related, following the same logic?

(A) KLNO
(B) KLNP
(C) JKNO
(D) LKNO

Q.18

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 10, ?, 46, 94, 190, 382, 766

(A) 20
(B) 22
(C) 18
(D) 24

Q.20

3 is related to 40 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 5 is related to 66. To which of the following is 10 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding / subtracting / multiplying, etc., to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 131
(B) 125
(C) 129
(D) 127

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Limestone is composed of:

(A) aluminium oxide
(B) calcium carbonate
(C) iron oxide
(D) sodium carbonate

Q.2
What is the term for the gradual, sequential changes in species composition in an ecosystem over time?

(A) Succession
(B) Extinction
(C) Evolution
(D) Adaptation

Q.3
Which edition of 'Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana' has been announced in union budget 2023?

(A) 4.0
(B) 5.0
(C) 3.0
(D) 2.0

Q.4
Which of the following is NOT a drawback of the barter system?

(A) Difficulty in contractual payments
(B) Surplus goods are replaced with other goods
(C) Double coincidence of wants
(D) Lack of a common unit of value

Q.5
As per Census 2011, what is the average female literacy rate in India?

(A) 82.45%
(B) 74.34%
(C) 65.46%
(D) 60.76%

Q.6
Which brick-made minaret holds the record for being the world's tallest tower at 73 metres?

(A) Minaret of Turin (Italy)
(B) Minaret of Jam (Afghanistan)
(C) Qutb Minar (India)
(D) Kalyan Minaret (Uzbekistan)

Q.7
Which state hosted the 6th edition of Khelo India Youth Games in 2024?

(A) Tamil Nadu
(B) Telangana
(C) Karnataka
(D) Kerala

Q.8
The Aatmanirbhar Bharat Rojgar Yojana was implemented through which organisation?

(A) Employees Provident Fund Organisation
(B) Reserve Bank of India
(C) HDFC Bank
(D) Life Insurance Corporation

Q.9
Identify the tributary of the Brahmaputra River from the following.

(A) Barakar
(B) Kali Ganga
(C) Burhi Dihing
(D) Hindan

Q.10
Jallianwala Bagh is located in which city?

(A) Amritsar
(B) Chandigarh
(C) Ludhiana
(D) Ambala

Q.11
Children’s Day in India is celebrated to commemorate the birth anniversary of _____.

(A) Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru
(B) Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan
(C) Dr. APJ. Abdul Kalam
(D) Dr. BR Ambedkar

Q.12
Which Article of the Constitution of India describes a key feature of 'Universal Adult Franchise' that grants the right to vote to citizens, above the age of 18 years in India?

(A) Article 326
(B) Article 352
(C) Article 367
(D) Article 315

Q.13
The Hugli industrial region is located in which state?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Telangana
(C) Karnataka
(D) West Bengal

Q.14
Who among the following social reformers ruled out the practice of Sati on the basis of Hindu religious texts?

(A) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar
(B) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
(C) Swami Vivekanand
(D) Jyotiba Phule

Q.15
Both, Rajesh Prasanna and Rishabh Prasanna are associated with which musical instrument?

(A) Flute
(B) Piano
(C) Guitar
(D) Mandolin

Q.16
Which of the following was the mascot of the 37th National Games?

(A) Savaj
(B) Moga
(C) Ammu
(D) Chhaua

Q.17
How many covalent bonds are present between the constituent atoms in the molecules of Butane and Hexane, respectively?

(A) 14 and 20
(B) 10 and 16
(C) 11 and 19
(D) 13 and 19

Q.18
Which among the following dynasties originated from the Yueh-chih tribe of China?

(A) Satavahanas
(B) Parthians
(C) Guptas
(D) Kushanas

Q.19
Vinod Kevin Bachan has been selected for the Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar 2021, for his contribution to which Indian dance form?

(A) Odissi
(B) Sattriya
(C) Kathak
(D) Chhau

Q.20
The First Battle of Panipat (1526) marked the beginning of:

(A) Sultanat's rule in India
(B) French East India Company's rule in India
(C) British East India company's rule in India
(D) Mughal's Rule in India

Q.21
Which of the following classical dance styles manifests the element of sky?

(A) Kathakali
(B) Manipuri
(C) Kuchipudi
(D) Kathak

Q.22
How many fundamental duties were added by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act 1976?

(A) Thirteen
(B) Ten
(C) Fifty teen
(D) Eleven

Q.23
The novel 'Pinjar' that was later converted into a motion picture was written by:

(A) Amrita Pritam
(B) Dharamveer Bharati
(C) Krishna Sobti
(D) Ismat Chugtai

Q.24
Chili peppers produce a burning sensation in any tissue with which they come into contact. What is the compound responsible for this?

(A) Formic acid
(B) Lycopene
(C) Acetic acid
(D) Capsaicin

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Comparison
(B) Naviggetion
(C) Strengthen
(D) Cleansing

Q.2
The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. It was an insight / and determination of the lady doctor / that people were / able to lead a normal life.

(A) It was an insight
(B) that people were
(C) and determination of the lady doctor
(D) able to lead a normal life

Q.3
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks. I did not _____ that he would _____ the offer.

(A) bate; bait
(B) except; accept
(C) expect; accept
(D) bait; bate

Q.4
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. A majority of Indians prefer to use the Internet for _____ booking and other financial services.

(A) accessing
(B) attending
(C) dispersing
(D) improving

Q.5
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. Radha stepped "backward" to avoid the incoming traffic.

(A) Affront
(B) Beside
(C) Behind
(D) Forward

Q.6
Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Pull someone's leg

(A) To physically pull the legs of a person
(B) To avert a great danger
(C) To take a situation seriously or earnestly
(D) To tease or play a joke on someone

Q.7

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. My cousin thinks that / English is difficult / than other subjects.

(A) than other subjects
(B) English is difficult
(C) No error
(D) My cousin thinks that

Q.8

Select the option that correctly rectifies the underlined spelling error. Thank you for this jar of "asorted" cookies.

(A) asoted
(B) esorted
(C) assorted
(D) essorted

Q.9

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in future continuous tense form I shall come again in the afternoon for lunch.

(A) I will be coming again in the afternoon for lunch.
(B) I will come again in the afternoon for lunch.
(C) I shall have come again in the afternoon for lunch
(D) I shall be coming again in the afternoon for lunch.

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Only when the floods get _____ will world governments begin to act.

(A) frequently
(B) lucky
(C) gullible
(D) worse

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Attract

(A) Recur
(B) Repel
(C) Rear
(D) React

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Please pass _____ the salt.

(A) I
(B) me
(C) my
(D) mine

Q.13

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Mountaineering requires a combination of physical strength,"endurance", technical skill and mental fortitude.

(A) excitement
(B) enthusiasm
(C) timidity
(D) persistence

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank to complete the idiom and make the sentence meaningful. Her company's new product launch was a real _____ squib.

(A) deaf
(B) damp
(C) dear
(D) dirty

Q.15

The given sentence is divided into three segments. One of them may contain a grammatical error. Select the option that has the segment with the error. If there is no error, select 'No error' as your answer. Meenu looks/ much better/ today.

(A) Meenu looks
(B) today.
(C) much better
(D) No error

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Ramesh is fond "at" playing guitar in his free time.

(A) of
(B) on
(C) in
(D) for

Q.18

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. I thought of this idea / just when you called / me yesterday.

(A) just when you called
(B) I thought of this idea
(C) No error
(D) me yesterday

Q.19

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the highlighted word. The man had committed a "grave" offence so he was granted bail.

(A) trivial
(B) dignified
(C) serious
(D) solemn

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Fish live in aquariums and pigs live in _____.

(A) kennels
(B) sties
(C) stables
(D) dens

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. To forgive an injury is often (1)_____ to be a sign of weakness; it is really a sign of (2)___ . It is easy to allow oneself to be carried away by resentment and hate into an act of (3)_____; but it takes a strong character to restrain those natural passions. The man who (4)_____ an injury proves himself to be the superior of the man who wronged him, and puts the wrong-doer to shame. (5)___ may even turn a foe into a friend.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) given
(B) granted
(C) considered
(D) allowed

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. To forgive an injury is often (1)_____ to be a sign of weakness; it is really a sign of (2)___ . It is easy to allow oneself to be carried away by resentment and hate into an act of (3)_____; but it takes a strong character to restrain those natural passions. The man who (4)_____ an injury proves himself to be the superior of the man who wronged him, and puts the wrong-doer to shame. (5)___ may even turn a foe into a friend.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) strength
(B) aptitude
(C) intelligence
(D) usefulness

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. To forgive an injury is often (1)_____ to be a sign of weakness; it is really a sign of (2)___ . It is easy to allow oneself to be carried away by resentment and hate into an act of (3)_____; but it takes a strong character to restrain those natural passions. The man who (4)_____ an injury proves himself to be the superior of the man who wronged him, and puts the wrong-doer to shame. (5)___ may even turn a foe into a friend.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) jurisprudence
(B) overabundance
(C) noncompliance
(D) vengeance

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. To forgive an injury is often (1)_____ to be a sign of weakness; it is really a sign of (2)___ . It is easy to allow oneself to be carried away by resentment and hate into an act of (3)_____; but it takes a strong character to restrain those natural passions. The man who (4)_____ an injury proves himself to be the superior of the man who wronged him, and puts the wrong-doer to shame. (5)___ may even turn a foe into a friend.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) forgives
(B) involves
(C) contrives
(D) achieves

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. To forgive an injury is often (1)_____ to be a sign of weakness; it is really a sign of (2)___ . It is easy to allow oneself to be carried away by resentment and hate into an act of (3)_____; but it takes a strong character to restrain those natural passions. The man who (4)_____ an injury proves himself to be the superior of the man who wronged him, and puts the wrong-doer to shame. (5)___ may even turn a foe into a friend.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) Boldness
(B) Fondness
(C) Forgiveness
(D) Coyness

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.4 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(D)**

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**
Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**			

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(C)**

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.4 · Answer (A) 7 seconds

Running towards each other, the trains close at 50 + 58 = 108 km/h = 30 m/s. To pass each other completely they cover 110 + 100 = 210 m: 210/30 = 7 seconds.

Q.6 · Answer (B) 27

513 = 3^3 × 19, 1134 = 2 × 3^4 × 7 and 1215 = 3^5 × 5, so the HCF is 3^3 = 27.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 514 m

The perimeter is the curved edge plus the diameter: πr + 2r = 3.14 × 100 + 200 = 514 m.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 180 min

At 9/8 of its speed the train takes 8/9 of its usual time, saving 1/9 of it. 1/9 of the time is 20 minutes, so the usual time is 180 minutes.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 25%

Four shirts under the first offer cost the price of three, and the fifth costs 75% of its price under the second. He pays 3 + 0.75 = 3.75 shirts' price for 5: a discount of 1.25/5 = 25%.

Q.10 · Answer (D) 28

In proportion, 30 : 24 = 35 : x, so x = 24 × 35/30 = 28.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 6,693.75

5 years 3 months = 5.25 years. SI = 15,000 × 8.5 × 5.25/100 = ₹6,693.75.

Q.15 · Answer (C) 67 kg

The six weigh 6 × 62 = 372 kg. If the five friends average a kg, 5a + (a + 6) = 372, so a = 61 and Rakesh weighs 67 kg.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 12

The hemisphere holds (2/3)π × 12^3 = 1,152π cm^3 and each cone (1/3)π × 6^2 × 8 = 96π cm^3, so N = 1,152π ÷ 96π = 12.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 50.2

(40 + 49 + 56 + 68 + 38)/5 = 251/5 = 50.2 kg.

Q.19 · Answer (A) 980

SI = 3,500 × 7 × 4/100 = ₹980.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 1000

P = SI × 100/(R × T) = 360 × 100/(12 × 3) = ₹1,000.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (C) NL 24

The first letter moves back one, the second forward two and the number up two: R → Q, J → L, 17 → 19 and C → B, P → R, 12 → 14. So O → N, J → L, 22 → 24: NL 24.

Q.2 · Answer (B) 9

After interchanging the signs: 78 ÷ 6 – 6 × 2 + 8 = 13 – 12 + 8 = 9.

Q.3 · Answer (D) H

D sits on A's immediate left, and H is third to D's left (D is third to H's right), so H is four seats from A: directly opposite in a circle of eight. Fourth to the right of A is that opposite seat, whichever way the people face.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 20

After interchanging the signs: 24 ÷ 576 × 72 + 108 – 91 = 3 + 108 – 91 = 20.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 4
O is the only letter in both words and 4 the only digit in both codes, so O = 4.

Q.6 · Answer (C) rn
'book' is the only word in both sentences and 'rn' the only code in both, so book = rn.

Q.7 · Answer (A) G
Facing the centre, each person's left is clockwise. The clues fit only one order, clockwise: E, B, G, D, F, C, A. Counting three to the left of A: E, B, G.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Only conclusion I follows
Some oranges are apples, so at least some apples are oranges (I). All papayas are oranges, but nothing says any of them are among the apples, so II need not follow.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 17, 153
The second number is 9 times the first: 8 × 9 = 72 and 11 × 9 = 99. Likewise 17 × 9 = 153.

Q.13 · Answer (D) JDEHWXM
The word is reversed and each letter moved 3 places forward: MONKEY → YEKNOM → BHNQRP and NAP → PAN → SDQ. So JUTEBAG → GABETUJ → JDEHWXM.

Q.15 · Answer (B) OOK
First letters move back 3 (X, U, R, O, L), second letters forward 4 (C, G, K, O, S) and third letters back 4 (W, S, O, K, G): OOK.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
The statements allow every potato to be a tomato, so I need not follow. The tomatoes that are potatoes are not onions, but the other tomatoes may be, so II need not follow either.

Q.17 · Answer (A) KLNO
Each letter moves 3 places forward: CDFG → FGIJ and MNPQ → PQST. So HIKL → KLNO.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 22
Each term is twice the one before plus 2: 10 × 2 + 2 = 22, 22 × 2 + 2 = 46, 46 × 2 + 2 = 94, and so on to 766.

Q.20 · Answer (A) 131
The second number is 13 times the first plus 1: 3 × 13 + 1 = 40 and 5 × 13 + 1 = 66. Likewise 10 × 13 + 1 = 131.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) calcium carbonate
Limestone is a sedimentary rock made mainly of calcium carbonate, as the mineral calcite.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Succession
Ecological succession is the gradual, orderly change in the species of a community over time, from pioneer species to a climax community.

Q.3 · Answer (A) 4.0
The Union Budget 2023-24, presented on 1 February 2023, announced Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana 4.0.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Surplus goods are replaced with other goods
Barter is the direct exchange of goods for goods, so swapping surplus goods for others is simply how it works. Its drawbacks are the need for a double coincidence of wants, the lack of a common measure of value and the difficulty of deferred (contractual) payments.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 65.46%
Census 2011 put female literacy at 65.46%, against 82.14% for males.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Qutb Minar (India)
The Qutb Minar in Delhi, 72.5 m tall, is the tallest brick minaret in the world.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Tamil Nadu
The 6th Khelo India Youth Games were held in Tamil Nadu in January 2024.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Employees Provident Fund Organisation
The Aatmanirbhar Bharat Rojgar Yojana (2020), which paid the provident fund contributions for new employees, was implemented through the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO).

Q.9 · Answer (C) Burhi Dihing
The Burhi Dihing is a south-bank tributary of the Brahmaputra in Assam. The Barakar joins the Damodar and the Hindan the Yamuna.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Amritsar
Jallianwala Bagh, scene of the massacre of 13 April 1919, is in Amritsar, Punjab.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru
Children's Day, 14 November, marks the birth anniversary of Jawaharlal Nehru.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Article 326
Article 326 provides that elections to the Lok Sabha and the State Legislative Assemblies are held on the basis of adult suffrage: every citizen aged 18 or over may vote.

Q.13 · Answer (D) West Bengal
The Hugli industrial region grew up along the Hugli river around Kolkata, in West Bengal.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
Raja Ram Mohan Roy argued from the Hindu scriptures that they did not require Sati, and campaigned until it was banned in 1829.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Flute
Rajesh Prasanna and Rishab Prasanna, of the Prasanna family of the Banaras gharana, play the bansuri, the bamboo flute.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Moga
Moga, an Indian bison (gaur), was the mascot of the 37th National Games, held in Goa in 2023. Savaj was the mascot of the 36th Games, in Gujarat.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 13 and 19
An alkane C_nH_{2n+2} has n − 1 C–C bonds and 2n + 2 C–H bonds, 3n + 1 in all. Butane (n = 4) has 13 and hexane (n = 6) 19.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Kushanas
The Kushanas were a branch of the Yuezhi (Yueh-chih), a people of north-western China who migrated west into Central Asia.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Odissi
Vinod Kevin Bachan is an Odissi dancer; SSC's key gives Odissi as the form for which he received the Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar 2021.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Mughal's Rule in India
At the First Battle of Panipat (1526) Babur defeated Ibrahim Lodi, the last Delhi Sultan, and began Mughal rule in India.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Kathakali
SSC's key follows the popular pairing of five classical dances with the five elements, in which Kathakali stands for the sky (ether), Bharatanatyam for fire, Mohiniyattam for air, Odissi for water and Kuchipudi for earth.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Ten
The 42nd Amendment (1976) added ten Fundamental Duties in Article 51A; the 86th Amendment (2002) added an eleventh.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Amrita Pritam
'Pinjar' (1950), Amrita Pritam's Punjabi novel set during Partition, was made into a film in 2003.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Capsaicin
Capsaicin is the compound that makes chilli peppers hot; it acts on the nerve receptors for heat and pain.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (B) Naviggetion
'Naviggetion' is misspelt: the word is 'navigation'.

Q.2 · Answer (A) It was an insight
'Insight and determination' are made particular by 'of the lady doctor', so they take the definite article: 'It was the insight and determination of the lady doctor that...'

Q.3 · Answer (C) expect; accept
'Expect' means to think likely and 'accept' to agree to take: 'I did not expect that he would accept the offer.' 'Except' means leaving out.

Q.4 · Answer (A) accessing
One uses the Internet for 'accessing' (getting the use of) booking and other financial services; one does not attend, disperse or improve them.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Forward
The opposite of 'backward' is 'forward'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) To tease or play a joke on someone
To 'pull someone's leg' is to tease them, usually by telling them something untrue as a joke.

Q.7 · Answer (B) English is difficult
A comparison with 'than' needs the comparative: 'English is more difficult than other subjects'.

Q.8 · Answer (C) assorted
The correct spelling is 'assorted', with a double 's'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) I shall be coming again in the afternoon for lunch.
SSC's key gives 'I shall be coming', the future continuous ('shall/will be' + '-ing') that keeps the sentence's own 'shall'. 'I will be coming' is also future continuous, so it is arguable too.

Q.10 · Answer (D) worse
'Get worse' means become more severe: only when the floods get 'worse' will governments act. 'Frequently' is an adverb, and 'lucky' and 'gullible' do not describe floods.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Repel
To 'attract' is to draw towards; its opposite is to 'repel', to drive away.

Q.12 · Answer (B) me
'Pass' takes the object pronoun as its indirect object: 'Please pass me the salt.'

Q.13 · Answer (C) timidity
'Endurance' is the strength to keep going through hardship. Of the options, 'timidity', a lack of courage and boldness, is the nearest opposite; 'persistence' is close in meaning, and 'excitement' and 'enthusiasm' are unrelated.

Q.14 · Answer (B) damp
A 'damp squib' is something that fails to live up to expectations, like a firework that fizzles because it is damp.

Q.15 · Answer (D) No error
'Looks' is a linking verb followed by the comparative adjective 'better', strengthened by 'much': the sentence is correct.

Q.17 · Answer (A) of
'Fond' takes 'of': 'Ramesh is fond of playing guitar in his free time.'

Q.18 · Answer (C) No error
The sentence is correct: one thinks 'of' an idea, and the simple past suits both actions ('thought', 'called') on the same occasion.

Q.19 · Answer (A) trivial
'Grave' means serious; its opposite is 'trivial'. 'Serious' and 'solemn' are synonyms.

Q.20 · Answer (B) sties
A sty, or pigsty, is a pen for pigs; kennels are for dogs, stables for horses and dens for wild animals.

Q.21 · Answer (C) considered
Forgiving an injury is often 'considered', that is thought to be, a sign of weakness; the sentence goes on to say it is really the opposite.

Q.22 · Answer (A) strength
The contrast with 'weakness' calls for 'strength', which the passage confirms: 'it takes a strong character'.

Q.23 · Answer (D) vengeance
Resentment and hate carry one away into an act of 'vengeance', that is revenge.

Q.24 · Answer (A) forgives
The man who 'forgives' an injury proves himself superior to the man who wronged him.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Forgiveness
'Forgiveness', the passage's subject, may even turn a foe into a friend.

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